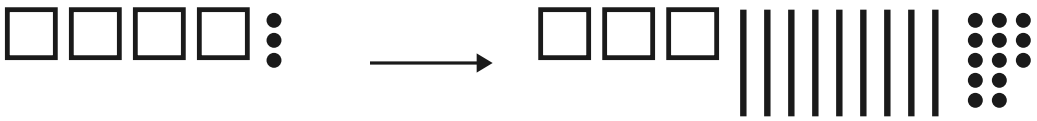
Subtracting Across Zeros

No tens to break? Think of the number as tens and ones.

403 – 157: 3 – 7? Break a ten. But there are 0 tens!



4 hundreds, 3 ones

Break a hundred into 10 tens, then a ten into 10 ones.

The shortcut: 403 is 40 tens and 3 ones

$$403 = 40 \text{ tens} + 3 \text{ ones}$$

$$403 = 39 \text{ tens} + 13 \text{ ones}$$

Take 1 ten from the 40 tens. Now there are 39 tens and 13 ones. One break!

Now subtract: 157 is 15 tens and 7 ones

tens	$39 - 15 = 24$ tens
ones	$13 - 7 = 6$
total	$240 + 6 = 246$

Check by adding:

$246 + 157 = 403$

Your turn!

$302 - 145 =$ ☐

break	302 = ☐ tens + ☐ ones
tens	☐ − 14 = ☐
ones	☐ − 5 = ☐
total	☐ + ☐ = ☐

Subtracting Across Zeros: Practice

Think of the top number as tens and ones. Break once.

Part 1 Tens and ones Write it as tens and ones, then break one ten.

1) 403 = ☐ tens + ☐ ones
403 = ☐ tens + ☐ ones

2) 702 = ☐ tens + ☐ ones
702 = ☐ tens + ☐ ones

3) 305 = ☐ tens + ☐ ones
305 = ☐ tens + ☐ ones

4) 600 = ☐ tens + ☐ ones
600 = ☐ tens + ☐ ones

5) 801 = ☐ tens + ☐ ones
801 = ☐ tens + ☐ ones

6) 506 = ☐ tens + ☐ ones
506 = ☐ tens + ☐ ones

7) 900 = ☐ tens + ☐ ones
900 = ☐ tens + ☐ ones

8) 204 = ☐ tens + ☐ ones
204 = ☐ tens + ☐ ones

Part 2 Break, then subtract The break row is done for you.

9) 402 − 135 = ☐

break 402 = 39 tens + 12 ones
tens ☐ − 13 = ☐
ones ☐ − 5 = ☐
total ☐ + ☐ = ☐

10) 703 − 248 = ☐

break 703 = 69 tens + 13 ones
tens ☐ − 24 = ☐
ones ☐ − 8 = ☐
total ☐ + ☐ = ☐

Subtracting Across Zeros: Practice (continued)

Part 2 Break, then subtract (continued)

11) **500 − 164 = ☐**

break 500 = 49 tens + 10 ones

tens ☐ − 16 = ☐

ones ☐ − 4 = ☐

total ☐ + ☐ = ☐

12) **610 − 253 = ☐**

break 610 = 60 tens + 10 ones

tens ☐ − 25 = ☐

ones ☐ − 3 = ☐

total ☐ + ☐ = ☐

Part 3 Fill in every box

13) **804 − 376 = ☐**

break 804 = ☐ tens + ☐ ones

tens ☐ − 37 = ☐

ones ☐ − 6 = ☐

total ☐ + ☐ = ☐

14) **301 − 127 = ☐**

break 301 = ☐ tens + ☐ ones

tens ☐ − 12 = ☐

ones ☐ − 7 = ☐

total ☐ + ☐ = ☐

15) **900 − 465 = ☐**

break 900 = ☐ tens + ☐ ones

tens ☐ − 46 = ☐

ones ☐ − 5 = ☐

total ☐ + ☐ = ☐

16) **520 − 148 = ☐**

break 520 = ☐ tens + ☐ ones

tens ☐ − 14 = ☐

ones ☐ − 8 = ☐

total ☐ + ☐ = ☐

Subtracting Across Zeros: Practice (continued)

Part 4 Stack it Cross out the tens, write the new tens and ones on top, then subtract.

17) hundreds tens ones

$$\begin{array}{r} 5\ 0\ 3 \\ -\ 2\ 7\ 6 \\ \hline \end{array}$$

18) hundreds tens ones

$$\begin{array}{r} 4\ 0\ 0 \\ -\ 2\ 1\ 8 \\ \hline \end{array}$$

19) hundreds tens ones

$$\begin{array}{r} 7\ 3\ 0 \\ -\ 3\ 6\ 4 \\ \hline \end{array}$$

20) hundreds tens ones

$$\begin{array}{r} 9\ 0\ 1 \\ -\ 4\ 5\ 2 \\ \hline \end{array}$$

Part 5 Zero in the tens No help this time.

21)

$$\begin{array}{r} 4\ 0\ 3 \\ -\ 1\ 5\ 7 \\ \hline \end{array}$$

22)

$$\begin{array}{r} 6\ 0\ 5 \\ -\ 2\ 3\ 8 \\ \hline \end{array}$$

23)

$$\begin{array}{r} 8\ 0\ 2 \\ -\ 4\ 6\ 5 \\ \hline \end{array}$$

24)

$$\begin{array}{r} 7\ 0\ 4 \\ -\ 3\ 2\ 9 \\ \hline \end{array}$$

25)

$$\begin{array}{r} 5\ 0\ 1 \\ -\ 2\ 8\ 6 \\ \hline \end{array}$$

26)

$$\begin{array}{r} 9\ 0\ 6 \\ -\ 5\ 4\ 7 \\ \hline \end{array}$$

27)

$$\begin{array}{r} 3\ 0\ 8 \\ -\ 1\ 5\ 9 \\ \hline \end{array}$$

28)

$$\begin{array}{r} 2\ 0\ 7 \\ -\ 1\ 4\ 8 \\ \hline \end{array}$$

Part 6 Zero in the ones No help this time.

29)

$$\begin{array}{r} 5\ 1\ 0 \\ -\ 2\ 3\ 4 \\ \hline \end{array}$$

30)

$$\begin{array}{r} 7\ 2\ 0 \\ -\ 3\ 8\ 5 \\ \hline \end{array}$$

31)

$$\begin{array}{r} 6\ 4\ 0 \\ -\ 1\ 7\ 2 \\ \hline \end{array}$$

32)

$$\begin{array}{r} 8\ 3\ 0 \\ -\ 4\ 5\ 6 \\ \hline \end{array}$$

Subtracting Across Zeros: Practice (continued)

Part 6 Zero in the ones (continued)

33)
$$\begin{array}{r} 450 \\ -\ 187 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$$

34)
$$\begin{array}{r} 910 \\ -\ 538 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$$

35)
$$\begin{array}{r} 370 \\ -\ 194 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$$

36)
$$\begin{array}{r} 260 \\ -\ 175 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$$

Part 7 Two zeros No help this time.

37)
$$\begin{array}{r} 300 \\ -\ 128 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$$

38)
$$\begin{array}{r} 500 \\ -\ 246 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$$

39)
$$\begin{array}{r} 700 \\ -\ 351 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$$

40)
$$\begin{array}{r} 400 \\ -\ 163 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$$

41)
$$\begin{array}{r} 800 \\ -\ 472 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$$

42)
$$\begin{array}{r} 600 \\ -\ 289 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$$

43)
$$\begin{array}{r} 900 \\ -\ 537 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$$

44)
$$\begin{array}{r} 200 \\ -\ 146 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$$

Part 8 Mixed Break only when you need to.

45)
$$\begin{array}{r} 605 \\ -\ 302 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$$

46)
$$\begin{array}{r} 803 \\ -\ 267 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$$

47)
$$\begin{array}{r} 540 \\ -\ 315 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$$

48)
$$\begin{array}{r} 700 \\ -\ 425 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$$

Subtracting Across Zeros: Practice (continued)

Part 8 Mixed (continued)

49)
$$\begin{array}{r} 406 \\ -\ 138 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$$

50)
$$\begin{array}{r} 960 \\ -\ 580 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$$

51)
$$\begin{array}{r} 302 \\ -\ 185 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$$

52)
$$\begin{array}{r} 850 \\ -\ 624 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$$

Part 9 Check by adding No help this time. Do you get the top number back?

53) 246 + 157 = ☐

54) 177 + 128 = ☐

55) 365 + 245 = ☐

56) 226 + 274 = ☐

57) 318 + 282 = ☐

58) 459 + 141 = ☐

Part 10 Remember? Problems from earlier packets.

59) 65¢ + 25¢ = ☐

60) half past 7 = ☐

61) 352 + 216 = ☐

62) 64 + ☐ = 100

63) half of 86 = ☐

64) 2 halves = ☐ whole

Part 11 Word problems Break once. Check by adding.

65) A school has 400 pencils. The kids use 156 of them. How many pencils are left?

Number sentence _____

Answer ☐ pencils

Draw or show your work

Subtracting Across Zeros: Practice (continued)

Part 11 Word problems (continued)

66) A book has 305 pages. Mia has read 128 pages. How many pages are left to read?

Number sentence _____

Answer ☐ pages

Draw or show your work

67) There were 610 people at a game. Then 245 people went home. How many people stayed?

Number sentence _____

Answer ☐ people

Draw or show your work

68) A jar holds 500 beads. 274 beads are red and the rest are blue. How many beads are blue?

Number sentence _____

Answer ☐ beads

Draw or show your work

69) Challenge: A game needs 1000 points. Kim has 455. How many more points does she need?

Number sentence _____

Answer ☐ points

Draw or show your work

Check-In: Subtracting Across Zeros

Show what you know. No help this time. Score: _____ / 9

Part 1 Tens and ones

1) 903 = ☐ tens + ☐ ones

903 = ☐ tens + ☐ ones

2) 409 = ☐ tens + ☐ ones

409 = ☐ tens + ☐ ones

Part 2 Subtract Break once.

3)
$$\begin{array}{r} 6\ 1\ 0 \\ -\ 4\ 7\ 3 \\ \hline \square\ \square\ \square \end{array}$$

4)
$$\begin{array}{r} 8\ 0\ 2 \\ -\ 2\ 1\ 3 \\ \hline \square\ \square\ \square \end{array}$$

5)
$$\begin{array}{r} 9\ 7\ 0 \\ -\ 6\ 8\ 1 \\ \hline \square\ \square\ \square \end{array}$$

6)
$$\begin{array}{r} 8\ 3\ 0 \\ -\ 7\ 3\ 3 \\ \hline \square\ \square\ \square \end{array}$$

Part 3 Check by adding

7) 268 + 632 = ☐

8) 85 + 615 = ☐

9) 464 + 356 = ☐